New York University Tandon School of Engineering
Department of Technology Management and Innovation

MG-UY 2104 BLN2 – Organizational Behavior – 9/2/26-12/14/26
Fall 2026 – Syllabus

Professor: Dr. Carla L. Bowens

Class Meets: **Mondays and Wednesdays, 4:00–5:50pm**

- Monday: In-person: Jacobs Hall, 6 MetroTech Center, Room 204 – Brooklyn Campus
- Wednesday: Online via Zoom

To contact professor: clb8181@nyu.edu or carla.bowens@nyu.edu
Office hours: By appointment (arrange with Dr.Bowens)

Key Dates at a Glance:

Date	Assessment / Activity	Coverage
Sept 30	**SHARK TANK GROUPS CONFIRMED**	Teams finalized; first in-class group planning time
Oct 7	**UNIT TEST 1**	**Chapters 1–4**
Oct 21	**SHARK TANK GROUP WORK SESSION #1**	In-class planning/check-in
Oct 28	**UNIT TEST 2 (MIDTERM)**	**Chapters 5–7**
Nov 9	**ELECTION 2026: POWER & POLITICS IN ACTION**	**LIVE OB CASE STUDY – DUE**
Nov 18	**UNIT TEST 3**	**Chapters 8–11**
Nov 25	**SHARK TANK GROUP WORK SESSION #2**	OB analysis, research & presentation development
Dec 2	**AI LITERACY EXTRA CREDIT DEADLINE**	Up to +3 percentage points; 11:59 PM
Dec 2	**FINAL SHARK TANK WORK SESSION**	Presentation readiness, rehearsal & Q&A preparation
Dec 7 & Dec 9	**ORGANIZATIONAL SHARK TANK**	**SIGNATURE FINAL PROJECT PRESENTATIONS**
Finals Week	**UNIT TEST 4 (FINAL EXAM)**	**Chapters 12, 13, 16 & 18 / Comprehensive OB Integration**

Catalog Description:

This course focuses on the study of human behavior in innovative organizations. Emphasis is on teams, leadership, communication theory and organizational culture and structure. The course includes analyses of organizational behavior problems through case studies and participation in experiential learning.

Course Description

This is a semester-long course worth 4 credit hours. The course explores theories, research, and practices that help us better understand human behavior in organizations and apply those concepts to contemporary workplaces.

Topics include:

- *Motivation and job satisfaction*
- *Decision making*
- *Group dynamics and work teams*
- *Leadership and communication*
- *Power, politics, and conflict*
- *Organizational culture, structure, and design*
- *Impact of technology*
- *Work stress, organizational change, and career management*

Course Objectives

1. Introduce important concepts, ideas, controversies, and research findings in the field of organizational behavior.
2. Apply organizational behavior research and theory to contemporary work-life dynamics.
3. Use organizational behavior principles to analyze and solve individual, group, and organizational problems.
4. Develop knowledge, skills, self-awareness, and practical tools that support professional effectiveness, teamwork, leadership, and career development.

Course Structure

This course meets twice per week: **Mondays in-person** at the Brooklyn Campus and **Wednes online via Zoom. (link in Brightspace)**

Weekly classes include:

1. *Subject matter presentation and discussion*
2. *Group case analysis/problem resolution*
3. *Term project strategy sessions*

The course incorporates readings, lectures, group assignments, independent case reviews, MyLab learning, current-events application, and experiential activities. Students are expected to read assigned chapters and complete required MyLab work as directed before class. The overall design and content for our weekly classes will be: 1) subject matter presentation and class discussion, 2) group case analysis/problem resolution, and 3) term-project strategy sessions. Each of these components, along with their requirements and desired outcomes, will be discussed in detailed during the first several class meetings and then documented on our class page for continual reference during the semester.

Required online etextbook:

Organizational Behavior, 20th Edition, by Stephen P. Robbins and Timothy A. Judge, Pearson Education, Inc. ISBN-13: 9780135431719.

This course is participating in the Follett ACCESS program. The required course material for this course will be delivered digitally via a link available on your course site in Brightspace. The cost of the platform, which includes the textbook, will be added to your bursar bill as a "book charge." Pricing details can be found on the NYU Follett ACCESS website or on the NYU Bookstore site when you log in with your NYU ID or search by course.

If you prefer to purchase your course materials from another source, you must log in to the student portal, https://includedcp.follett.com/2015 and opt out of the program by September 17th. If you do not opt out by this date, the charge will remain on your account.

Please note: If you choose to opt out, you will lose access to the publisher's platform after the opt-out period closes.

GENERAL STUDENT SUPPORT THROUGHOUT THE SEMESTER:

For **24/7 Pearson Support,** please visit: **AskPearsonSupport.com**

Learning Time Rubric (Weekly Estimate):

Learning Time Element	Synchronous / Asynchronous	Time on Task	Notes
Weekly Lectures	Synchronous (Zoom & In-person)	2.5 hours	Real-time interactive sessions
Readings	Asynchronous	2 hours	Assigned textbook chapters and articles
Assignments	Asynchronous	2 hours	Weekly MyLab, quizzes, short exercises
Term Project	Asynchronous	1 hour	Begins Week 3, progresses throughout semester

Grade Breakdown

Course requirements and performance measurements:

The course uses four unit tests to provide students with frequent opportunities to demonstrate progress and receive feedback. **Unit Test 2- midterm examination**, and **Unit Test 4- final examination**. Assessments emphasize understanding and application of Organizational Behavior concepts to workplace and organizational situations.

Students will be graded on active participation, preparation, and professional engagement. Participation includes discussing assigned readings and MyLab material, supporting ideas with course concepts, contributing to classroom and online discussions, and collaborating constructively in group activities. Students will participate in group topic-analysis discussions and applied exercises designed to develop communication, synthesis, collaboration, and problem-solving skills. These activities connect course concepts to realistic organizational situations.

Regular attendance is required, and lateness is strongly discouraged. If a class is missed, it is the responsibility of the student to obtain the missed presentation information from classmates. **Irregular attendance and/or lateness will have an adverse impact on a student's grade.**

Students are also expected to turn off cell phones and other electronic communication devices, including laptops, tablets and ipads, prior to the beginning of the class. Students are also expected to demonstrate respect and consideration for their classmates at all times. **Eating food in class is not permitted,** but water and other soft drinks can be consumed. No trash is to be left on any desks or on the floor of our classroom. Therefore, every student should conduct themselves as a professional in their treatment to others and the physical (and virtual) space in which we will learn and work together. **For Zoom class sessions, students are expected to be present with their cameras turned on unless otherwise stated by the professor.**

Grading Criteria: Based on a total of 100%, each student's performance will be measured by the following:

Unit Tests (4 Total that include mid-term & final exams)	**40%**
Pearson MyLab Readings, Assessments & Assignments	**15%**
Class Participation & Group Discussions	**10%**
Election 2026: Power & Politics in Action	**5%**
ORGANIZATIONAL SHARK TANK — Signature Final Project	**30%**
TOTAL	**100%**

Unit Test Schedule:

Unit Test 1 — Chapters 1–4;

Unit Test 2 (MIDTERM) — Chapters 5–7;

Unit Test 3 — Chapters 8–11;

Unit Test 4 (FINAL EXAM) Chapters 12, 13, 16 & 18 / Comprehensive OB Integration.

Extra Credit: AI Literacy Modules: Students may earn up to +3 percentage points toward the final course grade by successfully completing the three optional AI Literacy Modules (+1 percentage point per module). Extra credit is outside the regular 100% course grading structure.

Election 2026: Power & Politics in Action

DUE DATE: Monday, November 9, 2026

This 5% current-events assignment uses the 2026 election as a live Organizational Behavior case study. The purpose is not to grade political beliefs or candidate preferences. Students will analyze observable examples of power, influence, coalitions, dependency, political skill, impression management, conflict, negotiation, and organizational politics.

Students will follow credible election coverage before, during, and immediately after Election Day; identify three election-related observations; connect each observation to a Chapter 13 Organizational Behavior concept; and explain a comparable workplace application. Discussion standard: analyze the behavior, not the political position.

"SHARK TANK" – Signature Final Project (based on TV Show format/style)

ORGANIZATIONAL SHARK TANK represents 30% of the course grade. Teams of approximately 6–7 students will research and analyze a real company and present their findings to a panel of 'Sharks'—professionals and leaders who will evaluate the team's understanding, insight, application, and delivery.

Shark Tank Group Formation

Students will have an opportunity during the early weeks of the semester to become acquainted with classmates before groups are finalized. All Shark Tank groups will be finalized and confirmed by the instructor by Wednesday, September 30. Once groups are confirmed, teams should begin communicating, identifying roles, and developing a plan for completing the project.

In-Class Shark Tank Group Sessions

Designated class meetings throughout the semester will include Shark Tank Group Work Sessions. During these sessions, teams will have dedicated class time to organize responsibilities, discuss Organizational Behavior concepts, develop their analysis, and prepare the final presentation. These sessions support—but do not replace—independent group collaboration. Teams are expected to meet and work together outside of scheduled class time as necessary to successfully complete the project.

Project format: 10-minute team presentation; 10-minute Q&A; and a 2–3 page double-spaced group paper. The analysis should address the company overview; leadership and management; workplace culture; compensation and benefits; organizational biases/equity issues; industry position and competitors; innovation and future outlook; and application of at least three Organizational Behavior theories/models.

Internal project rubric: Content Depth & Accuracy – 25 points; Application of OB Theories – 25 points; Presentation Delivery – 20 points; Q&A Response – 15 points; Team Collaboration – 15 points. The 100-point project rubric is converted to the 30% course-weight value. Private team evaluation may inform the Team Collaboration component.

My Lab Expectations

Pearson MyLab supports chapter readings and course concepts with activities such as quizzes, dynamic study modules, simulations, surveys, concept checks, videos, and other assigned exercises. Only activities specifically assigned in the Fall 2026 MyLab course are required. Students should follow this section's Brightspace/MyLab calendar rather than dates from another section. Chapter quizzes allow two attempts, with the highest score recorded.

Course Communication:

- **Announcements**: Posted on Brightspace; check regularly.
- **Discussion Forums**: Weekly online discussions for engagement and feedback.
- **Virtual Meetings**: Weekly Zoom sessions for lecture and Q&A.
- **Netiquette**: Use respectful, professional language in all interactions.
- **Interaction Policy**: Active participation in Brightspace modules, forums, and meetings is required.

Generative AI Use:

Students may use generative AI tools (e.g., ChatGPT) for brainstorming and drafting support only when permitted by the assignment. Any AI-assisted content must be properly acknowledged and critically evaluated. Submitting unacknowledged AI-generated work as one's own may constitute academic dishonesty.

AI LITERACY MODULES — EXTRA CREDIT OPPORTUNITY

Students may earn up to +3 percentage points toward the final course grade by completing the three self-paced AI Literacy Modules. This extra credit is optional and sits outside the regular 100% course grading structure.

Understanding AI — +1 percentage point
Using AI — +1 percentage point
Evaluating AI — +1 percentage point

Students may complete one, two, or all three modules. Successful completion of each module earns a Credly Digital Badge; completion of all three unlocks the AI Literacy Capstone Badge. The extra-credit **deadline is Wednesday, December 2, 2026, at 11:59 PM**. The AI Literacy Modules do not replace any required course assignment, examination, MyLab activity, or project.

Course Requirements

Participation is paramount to your success in this course. Be sure to log into NYU Brightspace multiple times a week, read all announcements and course content, complete all assignments on time, and complete weekly readings.

Course Schedule

Week 1: Wednesday, September 2:

Course Introduction; syllabus; What is Organizational Behavior? Chapter 1 begins. Course launch online. Students should review Brightspace and MyLab instructions.

Week 2: Monday, September 7 and Wednesday, September 9:

No class Monday, September 7 – Labor Day. Wednesday: Chapter 1, What Is Organizational Behavior? MyLab + discussion online.

Week 3: Monday, September 14 and Wednesday, September 16:

Monday: Chapter 1, What Is Organizational Behavior? MyLab + discussion in person. Wednesday: Chapter 2, Diversity, Equity & Inclusion in Organizations. MyLab + discussion online.

Week 4: Monday, September 21 and Wednesday, September 23:

Monday: Chapter 2, Diversity, Equity & Inclusion in Organizations. Wednesday: Chapter 3, Job Attitudes. MyLab + discussion.

Week 5: Monday, September 28 and Wednesday, September 30:

Monday: Chapter 3, Job Attitudes. Wednesday: Chapter 4, Emotions and Moods. MyLab + discussion. SHARK TANK GROUPS CONFIRMED Wednesday; brief first team planning time in class.

Week 6: Monday, October 5 and Wednesday, October 7:

Monday: Chapter 4, Emotions and Moods. Wednesday: UNIT TEST 1 – Chapters 1–4. No new chapter is launched on the test date.

Week 7: Monday, October 12 and Wednesday, October 14:

No class Monday, October 12 – Fall Break. Wednesday: Chapter 5, Personality and Individual Differences; online session.

Week 8: Monday, October 19 and Wednesday, October 21:

Monday: Chapter 6, Perception and Individual Decision Making. Wednesday: Chapter 7, Motivation Concepts. MyLab + discussion + SHARK TANK GROUP WORK SESSION #1 (brief in-class planning/check-in).

Week 9: Monday, October 26 and Wednesday, October 28:

Monday: Chapter 7, Motivation Concepts – applied motivation cases. Wednesday: UNIT TEST 2 – MIDTERM, Chapters 5–7.

Week 10: Monday, November 2 and Wednesday, November 4:

Chapter 13, Power & Politics: Election Watch. Tuesday, November 3 is Election Day observation (no course meeting). Wednesday: Power & Politics in Action – Election Analysis. Election 2026 assignment due Monday, November 9.

Week 11: Monday, November 9 and Wednesday, November 11:

Monday: Chapter 9, Foundations of Group Behavior. ELECTION 2026: POWER & POLITICS IN ACTION — LIVE ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR CASE STUDY — DUE. Wednesday: Chapter 10, Understanding Work Teams.

Week 12: Monday, November 16 and Wednesday, November 18:

Monday: Chapter 11, Communication. Wednesday: UNIT TEST 3 – Chapters 8–11.

Week 13: Monday, November 23 and Wednesday, November 25:

Monday: Chapter 16, Organizational Culture and Change. Wednesday: OB integration + SHARK TANK GROUP WORK SESSION #2 (analysis, research, and presentation development); check Brightspace for class instructions.

Week 14: Monday, November 30 and Wednesday, December 2:

FINAL SHARK TANK GROUP WORK SESSION: research/application workshop, presentation readiness, rehearsal + Q&A preparation. AI LITERACY EXTRA CREDIT deadline: Wednesday, December 2 at 11:59 PM.

Week 15: Monday, December 7 and Wednesday, December 9:

ORGANIZATIONAL SHARK TANK signature final project presentations. Monday presentations are in person; Wednesday presentations are online.

Week 16: Monday, December 14:

Course synthesis and final examination preparation. Unit Test 4 will occur during the NYU Final Examination Period at the date/time assigned or confirmed for this section.

Final Exam: Finals Week – Date/Time per NYU Registrar:

UNIT TEST 4 (FINAL EXAM) – Chapters 12, 13, 16 & 18: Comprehensive OB Integration. This open-ended assessment requires students to integrate and apply major Organizational Behavior concepts from the final course unit, while making meaningful connections to concepts studied throughout the semester. Students should be prepared to analyze realistic personal, professional, team, leadership, power/politics, culture, structure, and organizational-change situations using appropriate OB theories and evidence-based reasoning.

Course Policies

Late Work

Late work will be accepted only upon receiving prior approval by the professor and will be automatically lowered by one letter grade and/or points removed based on the degree of lateness. Any assignments expected to be submitted late should be communicated to the professor before being submitted.

Moses Center Statement of Disability

If you are a student with a disability who is requesting accommodations, please contact New York University's Moses Center for Student Accessibility (CSA) at 212-998-4980 or mosescsa@nyu.edu. You must be registered with CSA to receive accommodations. Information about the Moses Center can be found at www.nyu.edu/csa. The Moses Center is located at 726 Broadway on the 2nd floor.

NYU School of Engineering Policies and Procedures on Academic Misconduct *(from the School of Engineering Student Code of Conduct)*

A. Introduction: The School of Engineering encourages academic excellence in an environment that promotes honesty, integrity, and fairness, and students at the School of Engineering are expected to exhibit those qualities in their academic work. It is through the process of submitting their own work and receiving honest feedback on that work that students may progress academically. Any act of academic dishonesty is seen as an attack upon the

School and will not be tolerated. Furthermore, those who breach the School's rules on academic integrity will be sanctioned under this Policy. Students are responsible for familiarizing themselves with the School's Policy on Academic Misconduct.

B. Definition: Academic dishonesty may include misrepresentation, deception, dishonesty, or any act of falsification committed by a student to influence a grade or other academic evaluation. Academic dishonesty also includes intentionally damaging the academic work of others or assisting other students in acts of dishonesty. Common examples of academically dishonest behavior include, but are not limited to, the following:

    1. Cheating: intentionally using or attempting to use unauthorized notes, books, electronic media, or electronic communications in an exam; talking with fellow students or looking at another person's work during an exam; submitting work prepared in advance for an in-class examination; having someone take an exam for you or taking an exam for someone else; violating other rules governing the administration of examinations.
    2. Fabrication: including but not limited to, falsifying experimental data and/or citations.
    3. Plagiarism: intentionally or knowingly representing the words or ideas of another as one's own in any academic exercise; failure to attribute direct quotations, paraphrases, or borrowed facts or information.
    4. Unauthorized collaboration: working together on work that was meant to be done individually.
    5. Duplicating work: presenting for grading the same work for more than one project or in more than one class, unless express and prior permission has been received from the course instructor(s) or research adviser involved.
    6. Forgery: altering any academic document, including, but not limited to, academic records, admissions materials, or medical excuses.

    Access the entire School of Engineering Student Code of Conduct here: engineering.nyu.edu/academics/code-of-conduct

Statement On Inclusion

The NYU Tandon School values an inclusive and equitable environment for all our students. I hope to foster a sense of community in this class and consider it a place where individuals of all backgrounds, beliefs, ethnicities, national origins, gender identities, sexual orientations, religious and political affiliations, and abilities will be treated with respect. It is my intent that all students' learning needs be addressed both in and out of class and that the diversity that students bring to this class be viewed as a resource, strength, and benefit. If this standard is not being upheld, please feel free to speak with me.

Final Exam Policy

UNIT TEST 4 serves as the Final Examination and covers Chapters 12, 13, 16 & 18 – Comprehensive OB Integration. The examination will occur during the NYU final examination period at the date, time, and location assigned or confirmed for this section. Final instructions and examination details will be posted in Brightspace.